



Samsung SGH-D500



The D500 is the latest head-turner from Samsung. Measuring 93.5 x 45.7 x 23.6 mm and weighing just 99 gm, it is pocketable! Encased in its beautiful piano-black outfit, this phone looks great. Clever user of chrome plays up well with its sublime beauty.

The brilliant 262K colour display screen is mesmerising and razor sharp. Just below the screen, on a bevelled edge, is the navigational four-way pad, flanked by two soft menu buttons. The call receive and hang-up buttons are below these.

A simple nudge to the slider opens up the well-lit keypad sporting reasonably sized keys. On the back panel, opening the slider reveals the 1.3 MP camera and flash. The quality of photos taken, though good enough, are not nearly as good as other phones in this article. Video recording is also supported with a 4X zoom feature. The integrated flash, as expected, is only effective at short ranges.

Samsung has devised an external speaker for this phone. MP3 playback via the inbuilt speaker is decent and adding the external speaker makes it

even better. The well-designed conical module plugs into the sides of the phone to provide richer audio.

Connectivity options include Bluetooth, USB and IR. Other features include video and voice recording, 64 polyphonic ringtones, SMS, EMS, MMS, e-mail, and Java 2.0.

Standard applications include World Time, multiple alarms, calculator, converter, timer, stopwatch and organiser. Three Java games—Forgotten Warrior, Freekick and Arch Angel are pre-loaded. Memory capacity of the device is 96 MB, shared dynamically between applications. But, there is no provision for memory expansion.

In terms of usability, the phone provides a standard icon-based menu, accessible using the soft-key and the navigation button—simple to use and a low adaptation curve. The slider can be operated easily, making one-handed operation a breeze. A 'Voice Clarity' feature cancels ambient noise to enhance your conversation. Battery life is average at best, with the battery lasting between two and three days.

Priced at Rs 22,000, the D500 is a great phone for those who want a sleek camera phone with a high flaunt value.



1/2 pg H AD